Namyats

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Namyats is a convention for distinguishing weak and strong 4♥/♠ opening bids. It uses 4♣ and 4♦ opening bids to show strong hands with hearts and spades, respectively. This can help responder gauge his hand when considering whether to bid. The philosophy is that improving your slam-sniffing toolset is more important than 4-level minor suit preempts (the latter often inviting the opponents to bid 4-of-a-major anyway).

Opener's Bids

Opening	Meaning
4♣	7+ strong hearts and 8-9 tricks. Example: ♠AJ ♥KQJT9432 ♦KQ ♣3
4♦	7+ strong spades and 8-9 tricks. Example: ♠AKQT876 ♥K5 ♦A2 ♣63
4♥	7+ hearts and 7-8 tricks. Weaker than 4♣. Example: ♠98 ♥AQT87532 ♦A ♣J3
4♠	7+ spades and 7-8 tricks. Weaker than 4♦. Example: ♠AKJ65432 ♥Q32 ♦J ♣T

Note that other opening bids are also possible with similar one-suited hands:

Opening	Meaning
1♥/♠	Natural. Used when the hand is **too weak** to open at the 4-level (e.g. only a 5-card major suit).
2♣	Playing Standard American methods, this is strong and artificial. Used when the hand is **too strong** to use Namyats.
2♥/♠	Playing Standard American methods, these bids are weak two-bids - **preemptive**.
3♥/♠	Playing Standard American methods, these bids are also **preemptive**.

Responder's Bids

In response to 4♣

Response	Meaning
4♦	Artificial relay, showing slam interest in hearts. Opener is expected to clarify his hand.
4♥	Signoff, showing no interest in slam. Opener is expected to pass.
4♠	Natural, showing a big one-suited hand in spades. Very rare. Not forcing.

In response to 4♦

Bid	Meaning
4♥	Artificial relay, showing slam interest in spades. Opener is expected to clarify his hand.
4♠	Signoff, showing no interest in slam. Opener is expected to pass.

In response to 4♥/♠

Responder may make a conventional reply like 4NT Blackwood, 5NT Grand Slam Force, etc. These responses are based on partnership agreement.

Opener's Rebids

There are many flavors of Namyats used after a 4♦/♥ relay. The simplest approach is:

- After a 4♦/♥ relay from responder, a 4♥/♠ bid by opener is a natural signoff.
- All other bids are natural or follow partnership agreements (e.g. cue bids, 4NT Blackwood, etc.).

In Competition

Typically, a double by the opponents of 4♣/♦ may either be lead-directing or takeout.

A lead-directing double

Double	Meaning
4♣-X	Lead-directing double for clubs.
4♦-X	Lead-directing double for diamonds.

A takeout double of opener's suit

Double	Meaning
4♣-X	Takeout double of hearts.
4♦-X	Takeout double of spades.

Against the latter approach, a redouble indicates general high-card values with interest in penalizing the opponents. It implies lack of support for partner's suit.

Conventional Namyats responses over a double are still on.

Responder's bids are natural over any overcall.

Examples

Opener	Responder
♠AKJT9872	♠3
♥A9	♥KQJ873
♦J	♦T98
♣K5	♣643

Opener	Responder
4♦ (1)	4♠ (2)
Pass	

1. 4♦ shows 7+ strong spades and 8-9 tricks.
2. 4♠ is a signoff.

Opener	Responder
♠62	♠KT5
♥AKJT9875	♥Q63
♦J	♦KQT3
♣K5	♣AJT

Opener	Responder
4♣ (1)	4♦ (2)
4♥ (3)	Pass

1. 4♣ shows 7+ strong hearts and 8-9 tricks.
2. 4♦ is a relay. With 15 HCP and heart support, responder is interested in slam.
3. 4♥ indicates a minimum. Opener only has 8 winners (7.5 hearts, 0.5 clubs).

Opener	Responder
♠A9	♠KQ5
♥AKJ98742	♥Q63
♦J	♦KQT3
♣K5	♣AJT

Opener	Responder
4♣ (1)	4♦ (2)
4♠ (3)	4NT(4)
5♥ (5)	6♥ (6)
Pass	

1. 4♣ shows 7+ strong hearts and 8-9 tricks.
2. 4♦ is a relay. With 17 HCP and heart support, responder is clearly interested in slam.
3. 4♠ is a cuebid. With approximately 9 winners (1 spade, 7.5 hearts, 0.5 clubs), opener is willing to go beyond 4♥ to probe for slam.
4. 4NT is Blackwood, asking for aces.
5. 5♥ shows two aces.
6. 6♥ is a signoff.

Origins

Namyats is "Stayman" spelled backwards. It was invented by Victor Mitchell, who was Sam Stayman's bridge partner in the mid-20th century. Both players dominated the American bridge scene during their era.

See also

- Alder Transfer Preempts
  A system of 3- and 4-level transfer preempts.